

Marketing Cloud Readiness Overview

Driving Readiness, Maximizing Success in the Cloud.



MC Next Business Units

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Version: Spring '26 (Release 260)

Role: Success Resource

Delivery Type: Expert Coaching Session / Strategic Architecture Workshop

Target Audience: Marketing Cloud Admins, Enterprise Architects, Marketing Operations Leaders

INTERNAL USE ONLY — Not for customer distribution. Audience tiers are noted throughout.

👤 Who Are You?

- 🎯 CSM/Success Guide → [Jump to: Value Prop & Qualification | Action Plan](#)
- 🏗️ Architect/SE → [Jump to: Technical Deep Dive | Limitations | Implementation](#)
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- 🔄 MCE/MCAE TRANSITION CONSIDERATIONS → [Jump to: Feature Comparison | Transition Architecture Patterns](#)

🚀 QUICK START (All Personas — 5 min read)

What Are Business Units?

- **Definition:** Business Units (BUs) are a mechanism to logically divide and manage marketing activities, acting as a junction between data and content.
- **The "Why":** They solve the problem of partitioning marketing data and content for complex, multi-divisional organizations (e.g., brands, regions, product lines).
- **Key Differentiator:** Unlike competitors that only separate content, Salesforce BUs provide "high walls" for data segregation at the source by leveraging Data Cloud architecture.
- **Edition Requirement:** Available exclusively in **Marketing Cloud Next Advanced Edition**.

When to Use BUs vs. Alternatives

- **Use BUs when:** A single org needs strict data isolation between divisions (Division A cannot see Division B's data) with separate Data Spaces.

- **Consider Data Cloud Governance instead when:** The need is for tagging/policy-based data access rather than full structural partitioning.
- **Both can be combined** depending on the customer's information architecture.
- **Channel & Consent Alignment:** In 260, channels (authenticated domains, SMS codes, WhatsApp sender codes) and communication subscriptions can be scoped **Global** (shared across all BUs) or **Per BU** (isolated to a single BU). This means opt-out in one BU does not affect another — critical for brand separation (e.g., Old Navy vs. Banana Republic).
- **Content Alignment:** CMS Workspaces are BU-specific. A BU has a 1:N relationship with its Workspaces — content is filtered to only what belongs to that BU's Data Space. Cross-BU content traversal is not possible in 260 (roadmapped for 262).
- **Use BUs when:** A single org needs strict data isolation between divisions (Division A cannot see Division B's data) with separate Data Spaces.
- **Consider Data Cloud Governance instead when:** The need is for tagging/policy-based data access rather than full structural partitioning.
- **Both can be combined** depending on the customer's information architecture.

Critical "Must Know" Limitations

- **Scale:** Hard limit of **50 BUs** per org (up from 10 in 258 MVP).
- **Immutability:** Once a Data Space is assigned to a BU, it is **permanent and cannot be changed**.
- **No Deletion:** BU deletion is not supported in 258 or 260 (tentatively roadmapped for 262).
- **No Cross-BU Content Sharing:** Content cannot be shared across BUs (roadmapped for 262).
- **No Horizontal Scale:** All BUs share the same underlying system resources (storage, processing, API limits) within the tenant.

Who to Contact for Help

- Primary Slack channel: [#help-csg-marketingcloud-next](#)
- Business Units dedicated channel: [#uma-business-units-dc1-ndd-public](#)
- Sales questions: [#help-sell-marketingcloud-growth-advanced-editions](#)

CSM/SUCCESS GUIDE PATH

Discovery & Qualification Framework

Decision Tree Conversation Starters:

- "Do you have multiple Salesforce core orgs, or do you need to partition data and content within a single org?"
- "Do you require strict data isolation where Division A explicitly cannot see Division B's data?"
- "Are you prepared to manage separate Data Spaces for each division?"

Red Flags / Disqualifiers:

- Customer wants to share content across divisions natively — not supported until 262+.
- Customer expects a "Parent BU" with automatic rollup — no native hierarchy exists.
- Customer wants to reverse a Data Space assignment after BU creation — not possible until **262**
- Customer is not on **Marketing Cloud Next Advanced Edition** — BUs require this license.
- Customer expects cross-BU consent sharing to be configurable at a subset level (e.g., some but not all BUs share opt-out) — this is a 262+ consideration; in 260, scope is either Global (all BUs) or Per BU (one BU only).
- Customer expects to reuse an existing CMS Workspace across multiple BUs — not supported; a Workspace is bound to exactly one BU.
- Customer wants to share content across divisions natively — not supported until 262+.

- Customer expects a "Parent BU" with automatic rollup — no native hierarchy exists. (just a manual additional BU if hybrid data is a value add for customers)

✂ Competitor Positioning:

- **vs. HubSpot:** HubSpot separates content but cannot truly isolate data at the source. Salesforce BUs use Data Cloud Data Spaces for genuine "high walls" data segregation — critical for regulated industries.
- **vs. Braze:** Braze workspaces create fragmented silos with no cross-brand customer view. Salesforce BUs allow a configurable Top-Level BU with relaxed filters for global analytics, while maintaining per-BU isolation.
- **vs. Adobe:** Adobe's approach requires stitching together multiple complex tools. Salesforce BUs are natively built into a single platform — one setup node, one unified admin experience.

💰 Pricing/Licensing Requirements:

- Business Units Requires **Marketing Cloud Next Advanced Edition**.
- SKU: *Marketing Cloud - Business Unit* (Enterprise / Performance / Unlimited editions).
- **For MCE+ customers:** must quote both MCE BUs AND MC BUs.
- **For MCAE+ customers:** must quote both MCAE BUs AND MC BUs.
- Add-on SKUs (e.g., SMS) are purchased at the org level and apply across all BUs.
- Questions → [#help-sell-marketingcloud-growth-advanced-editions](#)

📈 Business Unit Volume & Performance Sizing

- **⚠ CRITICAL — Read Before Recommending BUs:** Business Units provide **organizational separation and data isolation**, NOT horizontal scaling.
 - All BUs within an org share the **same underlying tenant resources** — storage, API limits, and processing capacity. Adding more BUs does not increase platform throughput, send speed, or query performance.
 - Every BU SKU purchased is an investment in **governance and partitioning**, not in capacity. Use this table to set realistic expectations and guide BU architecture decisions **before** any licensing conversation.

Volume Tier	Total Contacts/Records per BU	Monthly Campaign Sends per BU	✅ Recommended Design	⚠ Performance Considerations
🟢 (Ideal)	< 1M contacts	< 5M sends	Single BU or 2-5 BUs for organizational clarity. Minimal overhead, excellent isolation.	Excellent performance. No constraints. Full BU feature set available.
🟡 (Viable)	1M - 10M contacts	5M - 50M sends	5-15 BUs with clear segmentation strategy. Consider a Top-Level BU for cross-BU reporting.	Monitor API usage closely. Plan Data Space DLO filter strategies early. Backfill may take longer at higher end.
🟠 (Requires Planning)	10M - 50M contacts	50M - 200M sends	Mandate Data Cloud Governance + BU combo. Engage Partner/PS for Data Space architecture design before quoting.	Shared API limits become critical constraint. Backfill indexing may cause temporary delays in record visibility.

				Schedule enablement during a Maintenance Window.
 (Architectural Review Required)	 50M contacts	 200M sends	Do NOT quote BUs without an architectural review first. Engage Professional Services + Product Team before any BU commitment. Consider multi-org DC1 architecture for true horizontal scale.	All BUs compete for the same tenant resource pool. High risk of API throttling, slow query performance, and backfill delays at this scale. Requires dedicated architecture engagement.

Cost vs. Value Reality Check — Know What You're Buying:

 Each Business Unit SKU is a meaningful per-unit investment. Before recommending multiple BUs, be able to answer these questions on behalf of the customer:

-  **"What business division requires true data isolation?"** →
 - BUs are justified when Division A must be structurally prevented from seeing Division B's data — brand separation, regional compliance, audience segmentation. If the answer is "we have a lot of contacts," that is **not** a BU justification.
 - Base it on **business divisions that require data isolation**, not on scale. If a customer says "we need 40 BUs because we have 40M contacts," that's a red flag — they're conflating segmentation with scaling.
-  **"Does this division have its own channels, consent requirements, and content?"** →
 - If yes, a BU is the right investment. Channel alignment, consent isolation, and CMS Workspace separation are the operational value drivers.
-  **"Will each BU perform independently?"** →
 - No. All BUs share the same tenant resources. A BU with 10M contacts experiences the same platform constraints as every other BU in the org. You are not buying isolated compute.
-  **"Can we scale horizontally with BUs?"** →
 - No. BUs are for **organizational partitioning**, not **capacity expansion**. For true horizontal scale, the answer is multi-org architecture (DC1 Companion org model).
-  **"What if we need more than 50 BUs?"** →
 - Hard platform limit in 260. Roadmap includes incremental increases in future releases. If a customer genuinely needs >50 divisions, evaluate multi-org strategy or Data Cloud Governance as an alternative for some partitions.
-  **The advisor framing:** *"Before we recommend multiple BUs, the business case needs to stand on organizational or compliance need — not on a performance expectation. If the driver is 'we have too many contacts for one BU to handle,' that's the wrong reason, and we'd be doing the customer a disservice by not saying so upfront."*

When to Escalate:

- Customer has >25M contacts and wants >20 BUs → Engage **Partner or Professional Services** for Data Space architecture design.
- Customer has >50M contacts or >200M monthly sends → Engage **Professional Services + Product Team** to evaluate multi-org strategy vs. single-org BU model.
- Customer expects BUs to solve performance/scale problems → **Re-qualify** — BUs are not a scaling solution. Redirect to Data Cloud Governance or multi-org architecture discussions.

Value Articulation by Use Case

- **Brand-Based Partitioning:** e.g., Gap Inc. — Old Navy (value/family) vs. Banana Republic (premium/upscale) require entirely separate campaigns, audiences, and sender identities. In 260, each brand can have its own scoped SMS codes, authenticated domains, and opt-out preferences — a customer unsubscribing from Old Navy does not affect Banana Republic.
- **Regional Compliance (GDPR scenarios):** e.g., Netflix LATAM vs. Netflix Europe — separate data residency, language, and consent management per region. Per-BU consent scoping in 260 directly supports this.
- **Line-of-Business Separation:** e.g., Ford Cars vs. Ford Trucks — autonomous marketing teams with separate data, content, and channel identities.
- **Audience-Based:** e.g., Pfizer — consumers vs. healthcare professionals require fundamentally different messaging, tone, compliance posture, and sender identity.



Customer Action Plan

Pre-Engagement Checklist:

- ☐ Confirm customer is on MC Next Advanced Edition.
- ☐ Verify at least **two active Data Spaces** exist (or are planned) in Data Cloud Setup.
- ☐ Confirm customer understands the Data Space assignment is **permanent**.
- ☐ Identify if any in-flight campaigns/flows need awareness during backfill.
- ☐ Schedule enablement during a **Maintenance Window** for large orgs.
- ☐ Determine channel scoping strategy: which channels/SMS codes/domains should be **Global** vs. **Per BU**.
- ☐ Determine consent/subscription scoping: should opt-out be shared across all BUs or isolated per BU?
- ☐ Identify content ownership: which CMS Workspaces align to which BU, and confirm no content reuse is expected across BUs.

Stakeholder Mapping:

- **Strategic Leader (CMO/CIO):** Needs global analytics story + unified platform pitch.
- **IT/Architect:** Needs the 1:1 Data Space relationship, security model, and API details.
- **Marketing Admin:** Needs step-by-step enablement, user management, and governance guidance.
- **Marketer:** Needs to understand the BU switcher, role access, and what they can/cannot see.

Timeline Expectations:

- Backfill is generally fast; large orgs with millions of records may see a temporary delay in record visibility during indexing.
- Full BU functionality is only exposed after a **second BU is created** — the "Initial BU" is implied but not surfaced until then.

Partner Engagement Criteria:

- Engage a Partner or internal architect when the customer needs: Data Space design/architecture, complex DLO filter configuration, or migration from MCE/MCAE BUs.

Closing Script:

"We have validated that Business Units are the right fit for your multi-brand strategy. Your homework is to configure that secondary Data Space. Once that is ready, you can proceed with the setup steps we reviewed. Do you have a Partner or internal architect ready to handle the data mapping?"



ARCHITECT/SE PATH



Technical Architecture Deep Dive

Data Space to BU Relationship (1:1 Enforcement):

- Each BU has a **strict 1:1 relationship** with a single Data Cloud Data Space.

- A Data Space can only be associated with **one** BU — no sharing.

CMS Workspace Relationships (1:N):

- A BU has a **1:N relationship** with CMS Content Workspaces.
- At least one Content Workspace is required and designated as the default (where out-of-the-box content resides).
- A CMS Workspace is **specific to a single BU** — cross-BU content traversal is not possible.
- CMS Workspace association only happens from the BU itself within Setup.
- **Content Filtering in Action:** When a marketer selects content on a Campaign or Flow, only content associated with that BU's Data Space and CMS Workspace(s) is shown. There is no bleed-through from other BUs.
- **Content Sharing (262 Roadmap):** Content syndication across BUs is not supported in 258 or 260. Workaround: duplicate content manually, or use a Top-Level BU's CMS Workspace as a centralized content source with relaxed filters.



Permission Model (2-Layer Security):

- **Layer 1 — Global Salesforce Permissions (Key to the Building):**
 - *Marketing Cloud Growth/Advanced User:* Baseline access to Campaign objects, Flows, and Content.
 - *Data Cloud User (or Admin):* Access to Data Streams and Calculated Insights.
 - *Flow User:* Required for activating and managing Flow-based campaigns.
 - Without these, the user cannot log in or see the Marketing tab.
- **Layer 2 — BU Membership / Contributor Role (Key to the Office):**
 - Having Layer 1 permissions does NOT grant access to a specific BU's data.
 - Users must be explicitly added as **Contributors** to each BU.
 - *Marketer - Standard:* Full access within BU boundaries. Can create Segments, activate Campaigns, publish Content.
 - *Marketer - ReadOnly:* Can view Dashboards and metrics, but cannot edit/activate. Ideal for Distributed Marketing/Field Sales.
 - Adding a user to a BU automatically grants them Content Manager access to all associated CMS Workspaces (260 enhancement).

Backfill Process Internals:

- Triggered **immediately and irreversibly** the moment "Enable Business Units" is toggled.
- Before enablement: Records (Campaigns, Assets) exist in a "Global" state (`BusinessUnitId = null`).
- After enablement: System creates the "Initial BU" and the backfill job stamps every existing marketing record with that BU's ID.
- **Scope of backfill:** Campaigns, Campaign Briefs, Flows (Active & Inactive), CMS Workspaces, Data Cloud Segments (from Default Data Space).
- **What does NOT change:** Data quality (messy data lands as messy data — no intelligent sorting), in-flight journeys (active flows continue uninterrupted — backfill is a metadata update).
- Perform during a **Maintenance Window** for large orgs.



Implementation Walkthrough

Pre-Requisites Validation:

1. Confirm org is on **Marketing Cloud Next Advanced Edition**.
2. Verify at least **two active Data Spaces** exist in Data Cloud Setup.
3. Confirm stakeholders understand the irreversibility of Data Space assignment.

Step-by-Step Enablement:

1. Go to **Data Cloud Setup** → Create two distinct Data Spaces (e.g., `DS_Global_Retail` and `DS_Luxury_Brand`).

2. Go to **Setup > Marketing Cloud > Setup Assistant** "Enable Marketing Cloud" (starting with Default data Space)
3. Go to **Setup > Business Units** → Click "**Enable Business Units**"
4. Observe the system auto-create the **Initial Business Unit** (100% of existing assets are swept in).
5. Click "**New Business Unit**" → Assign a Name and select the specific Data Space.
 - a. Enter the name and an optional description for your initial business unit.
 - b. Select whether consent and channels apply to all or a single business unit.
If you have created channels or subscription records, this option determines whether they're available only to this business unit or to all business units.
 - c. In the **Data Space Description** field, enter a description that includes the name of the related business unit.
The default data space is the same data space that you selected for your marketing org. The description helps you identify the related business unit when you create objects in the Marketing app where you select the data space instead of the business unit, such as when creating a segment.
 - d. Set the physical address of the initial business unit. If applicable, set the org address as the business unit's address.
 - e. Your current marketing configuration, including data space and content workspaces, are assigned to the initial business unit.
6. Click **Next**.
7. Confirm Data Space selection — **this link is permanent and cannot be swapped later**.
8. To add users to the first business unit, select **Marketing Cloud Admin**, **Marketing Cloud Manager**, or both permission sets, and then click **Next**.
9. Add the next business unit.
 - a. Enter the name, API name, and an optional description for your second business unit.
 - b. Select a data space.
 - c. Enter a name and API name for a marketing CMS workspace. A new workspace is created and assigned as the default workspace for this business unit.
 - d. Set the physical address of the second business unit, if necessary.
 - e. Click **Next**.
10. Make sure that the data space and marketing workspaces to be assigned to the business unit are correct. After you create a business unit, you can't edit or delete it.
11. Click **Done**.
12. Depending on your business requirements, create more business units on the Business Units page. Map each business unit to a unique data space.
13. If you add any users to the selected marketing permission sets later, add them manually to the business unit.

Post-Enablement Verification:

- Switch BU context via the User Profile dropdown and confirm list views show only that BU's data.
- Verify in-flight campaigns and flows are still running.
- Confirm backfill is complete before creating additional BUs or assigning new Data Spaces.

Data Space Strategy Design:

- Align BU names with Data Space names: e.g., BU **NA_Retail** → Data Space **DS_NA_Retail**.
- Design a "Top-Level" BU with relaxed DLO filters to aggregate data for global/cross-BU analytics (no native Parent BU exists - there's no hierarchy within BU's alignment is linear).
- Consider Data Cloud Governance tagging/policies as a complementary or alternative partitioning layer.

Scale & Performance Considerations

- **50 BU Limit:** Hard cap per org in 260; will be increased incrementally in later releases.
- **Shared Resource Constraints:** All BUs share storage, processing power, and API limits within the same Salesforce tenant — BUs are not a horizontal scaling solution.
- **API Limit Implications:** BusinessUnit object is exposed as read-only in the Data API (258). Connect APIs support CRUD and membership management. Record BU API supports Campaign, Brief, MarketSegment, CMS Workspace, Content, Dataspace, and Flow.
- **Data Space Sizing Guidance:** Each BU needs its own dedicated Data Space. Factor in DLO filter automation (260) to reduce manual overhead for large-scale deployments.
- **Channel & Consent at Scale:** Each BU can have its own scoped channels and consent subscriptions. Design your channel/consent topology early — retrofitting Global channels to Per-BU scoping after launch requires deliberate re-assignment and customer communication.
- **Content at Scale:** Each BU requires its own CMS Workspace(s). Factor in content duplication overhead when content sharing across BUs is needed until 262 syndication ships.



Volume & Sizing Guidance: See the **Business Unit Volume & Performance Sizing table** in the CSM path for detailed recommendations on how many BUs are appropriate based on contact volume and send volume.

Known Limitations & Workarounds

- **Immutability (Data Space Assignment):** No workaround — design Data Spaces carefully before enablement. This is a permanent architectural decision.
- **No Deletion (262 Roadmap):** BUs cannot be deleted in 258 or 260. De-provisioning is planned for 262. Workaround: use naming conventions to mark deprecated BUs.
- **No Content Sharing (262 Roadmap):** Content cannot be shared across BUs. Workaround: duplicate content manually or attach a centralized CMS Workspace to a Top-Level BU with relaxed filters.
- **Channel Scoping — No Partial Sharing (262 Consideration):** In 260, channels and consent are either Global (all BUs) or Per BU (one BU only). Selective sharing — e.g., a shared SMS code for 3 of 10 BUs — is a 262+ roadmap item. Plan channel topology accordingly.
- **Consent Isolation Design:** When a subscription is scoped Per BU, opt-outs are fully isolated. If Global, an opt-out in any BU affects all. This is a deliberate, irreversible design choice per subscription — confirm with the customer before setup.
- Now users can create BU's in Companion Orgs (whereas previously this was limited).
- **Einstein Metrics Guard:** Not supported when multiple BUs exist (temporary gap — will be resolved in a subsequent release).
- **Dynamic DLOs Not Fully Automated:** Flow Runs (FlowElementRun, FlowRun, IdentityMatch) and Personalization logs (PersonalizationLog, ExperimentationLog) still require manual filter configuration in 260.
- **Sandbox:** BUs can be copied to Sandbox for testing, but **cannot be deployed from Sandbox to Production**. Manual creation in Sandbox is allowed.



ONBOARDING/LEARNING PATH

Self-Paced Lab Exercises

Lab 1: Create Your First Data Spaces

- Go to **Data Cloud Setup**.
- Create two distinct Data Spaces (e.g., `DS_Global_Retail` and `DS_Luxury_Brand`).
- Observe the separation — you cannot demo BU value with only the default Data Space.

Lab 2: Enable Business Units & Observe Backfill

- Go to **Data Cloud Setup** → Create two distinct Data Spaces (e.g., `DS_Global_Retail` and `DS_Luxury_Brand`).

- Go to **Setup > Marketing Cloud > Setup Assistant** "Enable Marketing Cloud"
- Go to **Setup > Business Units** → Click "Enable Business Units"
- Observe the system auto-create the **Initial Business Unit** (100% of existing assets are swept in).
- Click "**New Business Unit**" → Assign a Name and select the specific Data Space.
 - Enter the name and an optional description for your initial business unit.
 - Select whether consent and channels apply to all or a single business unit.
If you have created channels or subscription records, this option determines whether they're available only to this business unit or to all business units.
 - In the **Data Space Description** field, enter a description that includes the name of the related business unit.
The default data space is the same data space that you selected for your marketing org. The description helps you identify the related business unit when you create objects in the Marketing app where you select the data space instead of the business unit, such as when creating a segment.
 - Set the physical address of the initial business unit. If applicable, set the org address as the business unit's address.
 - Your current marketing configuration, including data space and content workspaces, are assigned to the initial business unit.
- Click **Next**.
- Confirm Data Space selection — **this link is permanent and cannot be swapped later**.
- To add users to the first business unit, select **Marketing Cloud Admin**, **Marketing Cloud Manager**, or both permission sets, and then click **Next**.
- Add the next business unit.
 - Enter the name, API name, and an optional description for your second business unit.
 - Select a data space.
 - Enter a name and API name for a marketing CMS workspace. A new workspace is created and assigned as the default workspace for this business unit.
 - Set the physical address of the second business unit, if necessary.
 - Click **Next**.
- Make sure that the data space and marketing workspaces to be assigned to the business unit are correct. After you create a business unit, you can't edit or delete it.
- Click **Done**.
- Depending on your business requirements, create more business units on the Business Units page. Map each business unit to a unique data space.
- If you add any users to the selected marketing permission sets later, add them manually to the business unit.
- Key learning: **100% of existing assets** are swept into the Initial BU.
- Confirm in-flight flows continue running (backfill is a metadata update, not a service interruption).

Lab 3: Build the "High Walls" Demo

- Create a second BU named "Luxury Division" and link it to `DS_Luxury_Brand`.
- Create a specific Segment in the Initial BU.
- Use the User Profile dropdown to switch to the Luxury Division BU.
- Show the empty list views — "This is not a filter; this is a wall."

Lab 4: User Permission Assignment Practice

- Add a test user as a **Marketer - Standard** contributor to the Luxury Division BU.
- Verify they automatically receive access to associated CMS Workspaces (260 behavior).

- Add a second test user as **Marketer - ReadOnly** and confirm they cannot activate campaigns.

Certification Checkpoints

- ☐ Can explain the 1:1 Data Space to BU relationship and why it is immutable.
 - ☐ Can demo "high walls" isolation — showing that a BU switch is a wall, not a filter.
 - ☐ Can articulate 3 use case patterns (Brand, Region, Line of Business).
 - ☐ Can identify disqualification scenarios (no Advanced license, expects content sharing, needs BU deletion).
 - ☐ Can explain the 2-layer security model (Layer 1: global permissions, Layer 2: BU contributor role).
 - ☐ Can describe what backfill does and what it does NOT do (data quality, in-flight journeys).
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SUPPORT ENGINEER PATH

Troubleshooting Playbook

Backfill Job Stuck / Failed:

- Verify the enablement toggle was completed successfully in Setup > Business Units.
- Check for any active platform maintenance events that may have interrupted the job.
- For large orgs, a temporary delay in record visibility during indexing is expected — advise customer to wait before escalating.
- If backfill did not complete before a second BU was created, escalate to Product Team.

User Can't See Expected BU:

- Confirm user has **Layer 1 permissions** (Marketing Cloud Growth/Advanced User, Data Cloud User, Flow User permission sets).
- Confirm user has been explicitly added as a **Contributor** to the target BU (Layer 2).
- In 258, users must also be manually added to the Data Space as a separate step (automated in 260).
- Confirm the BU exists and has completed its backfill/setup.

Data Space Assignment Errors:

- Data Space assignment to a BU is **permanent** — there is no re-assignment path. If wrong Data Space was assigned, this requires creating a new BU.
- Confirm the Data Space is active and not already assigned to another BU (1:1 constraint).

Permission Conflicts:

- Confirm the user's Salesforce org-level permission sets are correctly assigned (Layer 1).
- For Marketer - ReadOnly users attempting to activate: this is expected behavior — they are restricted from campaign activation by design.
- System Admin users still require explicit BU Contributor assignment for audit trail compliance.

Known Issues & Workarounds (260)

- **Einstein Metrics Guard Not Supported:** Not available when multiple BUs exist. Temporary gap — will be addressed in a subsequent release. No workaround; inform customer of roadmap timeline.
- **Manual DLO Filter Scenarios:** The following Dynamic DLOs still require manual filter configuration in 260: Flow Runs (FlowElementRun, FlowRun, IdentityMatch) and Personalization logs (PersonalizationLog, ExperimentationLog).
- **Sandbox Limitations:** BUs can be copied to Sandbox and manually created there, but **cannot be deployed from Sandbox to Production**. This is by design.
- **No BU Deletion:** If a BU was created by mistake, it cannot be deleted in 258 or 260. Use naming conventions to flag it as deprecated.

- **Channel Scoping Confusion:** Customers may not realize that a channel set as Global cannot be re-scoped to Per BU without deliberate re-assignment. Advise customers to confirm channel topology before initial setup.
- **Consent Bleed (258 Orgs Upgrading to 260):** Orgs that launched on 258 with Global consent must actively review and re-scope subscriptions to Per BU if brand separation is required. This is not automatic on upgrade.
- **Content Not Visible Across BUs:** If a marketer reports missing images or email templates on a Campaign/Flow, confirm the content's CMS Workspace is associated with the correct BU — cross-BU content is intentionally blocked, not a bug.

Supported DLOs for Automated Filtering (260):

- **Static DLOs:** ManagedContent, ManagedContentPublishedUrl, Campaign, Flow, FlowRecord, FlowRecordElement, FlowRecordVersion, FlowRecordVersionOccurrence, MarketSegment, BulkMessage, ListEmail, Personalization, AbnExperiment, AbnExperimentCohort, AbnExperimentationDailySummary, AbnExperimentationSummary, PersonalizationDecision, PersonalizationPoint, PersonalizationRecommender, PersonalizationSchema
- **Dynamic DLOs:** Engagement, MessagingEventsSmsV2, MessagingEventsEmailV2, MessagingEventsWhatsAppV2, Instrumentation, BEHAVIORAL_EVENTS, CONTACT_POINT_ADDRESS, CONTACT_POINT_EMAIL, CONTACT_POINT_PHONE, IDENTITY, PARTY_IDENTIFICATION, OpportunityInfluence

Escalation Criteria

Engage Product Team when:

- Backfill job failed or did not complete and records are missing from the Initial BU.
- A Data Space was incorrectly assigned to a BU and the customer needs a resolution path.
- Einstein Metrics Guard issues beyond the known limitation.
- Unexpected behavior with automated DLO filters (260).

Engage Professional Services when:

- Customer needs Data Space architecture design or migration from MCE/MCAE BUs.
- Customer requires complex custom DLO filter logic for unsupported Dynamic DLOs.
- Customer needs Organizational Design consulting (Success Resource does NOT provide this).

REFERENCE LIBRARY (All Personas)

260 GA Release Notes

Admin Enhancements:

- Automated User Management — system auto-grants BU Contributors access to Data Spaces and CMS Workspaces.
- Automated Data Filtering & Routing — programmatic filter creation for most DLOs eliminates manual setup.
- BU limit increased from 10 → 50 per org.
- DC1 Companion org compatibility.
- Sandbox support (copy BUs to Sandbox; cannot deploy Sandbox → Production).

Marketing Features:

- Mobile App Messaging channel support.
- **BU-Scoped Channels & Consent:** Channels (authenticated domains, SMS codes, WhatsApp sender codes) and communication subscriptions can now be scoped Global (all BUs) or Per BU — enabling brands like Gap to have entirely separate opt-out preferences per division.
- BU-Scoped Physical Addresses.
- BU labels on Marketing Calendar and Data Space selection.

- Opportunity Influence now supported with multiple BUs.

262+ Roadmap Highlights

- BU de-provisioning/deletion.
- Content syndication (cross-BU content sharing).
- Business Unit implementation wizard.
- Agent-first / Slack-first BU operations.
- Cross-Cloud BU expansion (Commerce, Sales).

Official Documentation Links

- [Marketing Cloud Next Business Units - Spring 26: A Comprehensive Guide](#) (INTERNAL ONLY) - Complete technical specifications and implementation details
- [Business Units in Marketing Cloud Next](#)
 - [Enable Marketing Cloud Next](#)
Before you create your first business units, review the prerequisites, and enable Marketing Cloud Next for your org.
 - [Create Business Units in Marketing Cloud Next](#)
To get started with business units in Marketing Cloud Next, create the first two business units. The first two business units are created consecutively. Next, select the marketing permission sets for the users to add to the first business unit.
 - [Set Up Marketing Cloud Next for a Business Unit](#)
When you have multiple business units, you configure some Marketing Cloud Next settings for each business unit separately, and other settings for the overall org. This means that you complete some tasks on the Business Units Setup page, some tasks in the Marketing Cloud Next Setup Assistant, and other tasks on specialized setup for messaging channels or other features.
 - [Assign a Communication Subscription to Business Units](#)
When you create a communication subscription, you can assign it to either a single business unit or all business units. All existing subscriptions are assigned to all business units. A subscription's business unit assignment determines which channels can be added to it and in which business units it can be used.
 - [Working with Campaigns in Business Units](#)
When you create a campaign, you must also select a business unit to relate to the campaign.
 - [Working with CMS Workspaces in Business Units](#)
When you create, organize, and share content in a marketing CMS workspace, keep these business unit considerations in mind.

Internal Slack Channels

- Primary Slack channel: [#help-csg-marketingcloud-next](#)
- Business Units dedicated channel: [#uma-business-units-dc1-ndd-public](#)
- Sales questions: [#help-sell-marketingcloud-growth-advanced-editions](#)

Demo Environments & Resources

- [Marketing Cloud Next Business Units - Spring 26: A Comprehensive Guide](#) (INTERNAL ONLY)
- [Marketing Cloud Business Units Overview - Deck / Recording](#) - March 2026
- [Solution Overview](#) (Winter 25' - 258)
- [Video Demo](#)
- [Demo Guide](#)
- [Business Units | Setup and Licensing](#)

- [Business Units | Flows](#)
- [Business Units | Campaigns](#)
- [Business Units | Brief](#)

Critical Note: Business Units are marketing-only solutions with strict technical limitations. Ensure all resources understand the 1:1 Data Space relationship, immutability constraints, and the irreversibility of BU enablement before any customer engagement.

MCE/MCAE TRANSITION CONSIDERATIONS

When Should MCE/MCAE Customers Adopt MC Next BUs?

CRITICAL READINESS TIMELINE:

- **MCE Customers:** Ready NOW (260+). Mapping infrastructure exists, consent is Global (260), Global + Per-BU consent available in 262.
- **MCAE Customers:**  **NOT RECOMMENDED until 262+ (BU mapping) and 264 (consent alignment).** User experience and transition path are **not production-ready** before these releases.

 **What MCAE customers can do NOW:** While BU adoption should wait, MCAE+ customers have active Phase 1 use cases available today — including **Agentforce capabilities, multi-channel messaging (SMS, WhatsApp), and advanced segmentation via MC Growth/Advanced.** Direct customers to the MCAE+ DRD for Phase 1 guidance so they are not in a "wait and do nothing" holding pattern during the 264 consent gap.

MCE vs. MCAE vs. MC Next BUs — Feature Comparison

Feature	Marketing Cloud Engagement (MCE)	Marketing Cloud Account Engagement (MCAE)	Marketing Cloud Advanced (MC Next)	 Strategic Advantage of MC Next
 Data Partitioning	Physical Silos: Distinct subscriber databases for every BU.	Physical Silos: Distinct, standalone databases for every BU. Prospects are siloed at the record level.	Logical Partitioning: Data Spaces with programmatic DLO filters.	Maintains Customer Data Privacy by providing brand/regional data isolation.
 Isolation Level	Hard physical isolation; users cannot see records or folders in other BUs.	Database Isolation: Hard isolation of prospects and assets; requires "Marketing Data Sharing" rules to sync to BUs.	Execution-Level Validation: Visibility of metadata (with Core Sharing) but restricted activation ("CRUD A").	Protects the point of sale by enabling collaborative activation.
 User Experience	Environment Switching: Requires reloading the app to switch BU contexts.	BU Switcher: Uses the Lightning App switcher; requires a context change to view different prospect sets.	Contextual Fluidity: Switch context via dropdowns/badges without page reloads.	Significantly improves marketers' interface.
 Content Management	Hierarchical folder structures; sharing via shared folders.	Folders & CMS: Internal folder structures; optional sharing via Salesforce CMS	CMS Workspaces: 1:1 or 1:N relationship between BU and workspaces.	Modern, visual management of content with filtered data.

		(if configured).		
 Hierarchy & Analytics	Parent/Child Model: Inherited hierarchy for vertical sharing and roll-up.	Flat Organizational Model: No native "Parent/Child" data hierarchy; BUs operate independently.	Top-Level BU: Optional BU with relaxed filters for cross-BU insights.	Leadership views with roll-up into a rigid hierarchy.

Transition Architecture Patterns

1:1 Mapping:

- Map each existing MCE/MCAE BU to exactly one MC Next BU.
- **Why it works:** Maintains operational consistency, minimizes risk, provides a strategic path to Unified Customer Identity.
- **Licensing:** For MCE+ customers, quote both MCE BUs and MC BUs, then discount MCE BUs down to \$0 to enable smooth transition.
- **Data Mapping:** For MCE customers, map EID (Enterprise ID) to the Default Data Space.

Hierarchy Consolidation:

- Collapse an MCE Parent/Child hierarchy into a flatter MC Next structure with a Top-Level BU for cross-BU analytics.
- **Why it works:** Modernizes rigid MCE hierarchies into flexible, filter-based aggregation.
- **Caution:** Requires re-architecting reporting and ensuring stakeholders understand there's no enforced parent rollup.

Consolidation (Multi-BU → Fewer BUs):

- Merge multiple MCE/MCAE BUs into fewer MC Next BUs where divisions can share a Data Space.
- **Why it works:** Reduces licensing costs and admin overhead when full isolation isn't required.
- **Caution:** Only viable if divisions can tolerate shared data visibility (filtered by segments, not walls).

Multi-Tenant Consolidation:

- Bring multiple separate MCE/MCAE tenants into a single MC Next org with multiple BUs.
- **Why it works:** Unifies fragmented instances into one platform for enterprise-wide analytics and Agentforce.
- **Caution:** High complexity; requires Professional Services for data migration and deduplication.

Multi-Org Expansion:

- Expand from a single MCE/MCAE org to multiple connected orgs in a DC1 (Data Cloud 1) architecture.
- **Why it works:** For decentralized organizations needing regional autonomy with central data aggregation.
- **Caution:** Requires a separate Marketing Cloud Next license for **every** connected org.

Platform	MCE	MCAE	MC Next
Readiness Status	✅ PRODUCTION-READY in 260+	🚫 NOT RECOMMENDED until 262+ (mapping) and 264 (consent)	✅ Available Now Business Unit implementation wizard (264)
Consent Management	Global now, Global + Per-BU in 262	Global + Per-BU NOT available until 264	Global and Per-BU scoping available
Legacy+ BU Coexistence	✅ Supported in 260+	🚫 NOT RECOMMENDED until	Native platform

Support		262+	
Transition Strategy	Existing MCE programs continue; new multichannel campaigns launch in MC Next	Engagement Studio programs remain in MCAE; transition path not production-ready	Launch new multichannel campaigns (SMS, WhatsApp, Mobile App, Email)
Timeline (customer maturity dependent)	Content Migration: 4-8 weeks User Training: 2-3 weeks Coexistence: 6-12 months	 Defer until 262+ (BU mapping) and 264 (consent alignment)	Immediate availability
Strategic Unlocks	● Unified Customer Identity: 360° view across MCE/ MCAE Contacts ● Agentforce Integration: AI across full customer base ● Multichannel Orchestration: Flow-based journeys		● Native multichannel capabilities, ● Agent-first / Slack-first BU operations (264), ● Cross-Cloud BU expansion (Commerce, Sales) (264)

When to Escalate to Professional Services

Engage Professional Services when the customer needs:

- **Data Space Architecture Design:** Mapping existing MCE/MCAE databases to optimal Data Space + DLO filter topology.
- **Custom DLO Filter Logic:** Complex filters for unsupported Dynamic DLOs or multi-tenant consolidation scenarios.
- **Multi-Org Consolidation:** Merging multiple MCE/MCAE tenants into a single MC Next org with deduplication and identity resolution.
- **Organizational Design Consulting:** Deciding how to structure BUs (1:1, hierarchy collapse, consolidation) based on business goals.
- **Content & Asset Migration:** Bulk migration from MCAE folders or MCE shared folders to MC Next CMS Workspaces.

Success Resources DO NOT provide: Data migration services, custom filter logic, or organizational design decisions.



MC Readiness Canvas Feedback

Hi! MC Readiness is always looking for feedback - help us improve this resource!

 **Start Workflow**